# The Quayside Post

Issue 37 · Autumn 2026
Staff newsletter of the Port Kellan Harbour Authority

PROJECTS

## New ferry terminal opens to passengers

After two years of construction, the new passenger terminal at the West Quay welcomed its first travellers on 14 September. The building replaces the old waiting hall, which had served the island ferries since 1974.

The terminal has heated waiting areas, step-free access to every gangway and a covered drop-off point for buses and taxis. Solar panels on the roof supply around a third of the electricity the building uses over a year.

Harbour master Gwen Tregarthen thanked the project team and the contractors for finishing the work without a single lost-time accident. She also thanked the ferry crews, who kept services running throughout the works despite the temporary berths.

Passenger numbers in the first month were 12% higher than in September last year. The ticket office will move into the terminal in November, once the new booking system has been tested.

A small exhibition about the history of the island ferries is on show in the arrivals hall until the end of the year. Staff who have photographs of the old hall are invited to lend them to the communications team for the next display.

### In this issue

- New ferry terminal opens
- Winter maintenance programme
- Safety: working near the quay edge
- Staff milestones

### Dates for your diary

| | |
|---|---|
| **6 Nov** | Open day for families at the pilot station |
| **20 Nov** | Fire drill, all harbour buildings |
| **4 Dec** | Charity quiz in the canteen, 18:00 |
| **18 Dec** | Last ferry before the holiday timetable |

### Did you know?

The harbour's tide gauge has recorded sea levels every six minutes since 1992.

## News in brief

### Canteen menu

From November the canteen will offer a hot vegetarian dish every day. Suggestions for new recipes can be left in the box by the till.

### Cycle shelter

A covered cycle shelter with twenty places has been built beside the gatehouse. Staff who cycle to work can collect a free light set from reception.

### Pilot boat refit

The pilot boat Kellan Star has returned from her refit with new engines. Fuel use on the first trial runs was almost a fifth lower than before.

## From the chief executive

This autumn has shown what the harbour can achieve when every team pulls in the same direction. The new terminal opened on time, the pilot boat is back in service and our safety record is the best it has been for a decade.

The months ahead will be busy, with the winter maintenance programme and the move of the ticket office. Please keep looking out for one another, and take the time to enjoy the holiday season with your families.

## Winter maintenance programme

Every winter the engineering team takes advantage of the quieter season to repair the quays and the lock gates. This year the programme runs from 9 November to 26 February.

### What will be closed

Berth 3 will close for six weeks while its fenders are replaced. The inner lock will operate on a reduced timetable during January.

### How to report a defect

If you notice damage to a ladder, bollard or railing, please report it in this order:

1. Make the area safe and warn other people nearby.
2. Take a photograph if it is safe to do so.
3. Log the defect in the maintenance app, giving the berth number.
4. Tell your supervisor before the end of your shift.

> *"A defect reported today is an accident that does not happen tomorrow."*

## Safety: working near the quay edge

Falls from the quay edge remain the most serious risk for anyone working in the harbour. Life jackets must be worn by everyone within two metres of an unprotected edge, including visitors.

New self-inflating life jackets are available from the stores in the engineering building. Each jacket has a service date on its label and must be returned for inspection when that date is reached.

### Cold water shock

In winter the water in the harbour is often below 10 °C. Sudden immersion causes gasping and rapid breathing, which is why a life jacket matters even for strong swimmers.

The safety team will run short refresher sessions on every shift during November. Ask your supervisor for the times that suit your team.

### Staff milestones this quarter

| Name | Department | Role | Years of service |
|---|---|---|---|
| Morwenna Pascoe | Marine operations | Pilot boat coxswain | 30 |
| Daniel Okafor | Engineering | Lock gate technician | 20 |
| Priya Raman | Finance | Accounts officer | 10 |
| Tomasz Wiśniewski | Security | Gatehouse supervisor | 10 |
| Elin Hughes | Customer services | Ticket office assistant | 5 |

Congratulations to all of them, and thank you for your service to the harbour.